

Robert A. Collinson

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Academic Positions

University of Notre Dame, Department of Economics, 2019-present

Wilson Family LEO Assistant Professor

Appointments and Affiliations

Faculty Research Fellow, National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER), 2024-present

Affiliate, Institute for Labor Economics (IZA), 2024-present

Visiting Appointment, Harvard University, Department of Economics, Spring 2022

Research Faculty, Lab for Economic Opportunities (LEO), University of Notre Dame, 2019-present

Faculty Fellow, Fitzgerald Institute for Real Estate, University of Notre Dame, 2019-present

Member, Human Capital and Economic Opportunity (HCEO), Inequality: MIP Network, 2019-present

Research

Journal Articles

How Do Changes In Housing Voucher Design Affect Rent and Neighborhood Quality (with Peter Ganong), 2018, *American Economic Journal: Economic Policy*, 10(2): 62–89.

Eviction and Poverty in American Cities (with J.E. Humphries, N. Madar, D. Reed, D. Tannenbaum and W. van Dijk), 2024, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 139(1), 57–120

The Long-Run Effects of America's Largest Residential Racial Desegregation Program: *Gautreaux* (with Eric Chyn and Danielle Sandler), 2025, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 140(3): 2213–2267

"Equilibrium Effects of Eviction Protections: The Case of Legal Assistance" (with J.E. Humphries, S. Nelson, S. Kestelman, W. van Dijk, and D. Waldinger)
Conditionally Accepted at American Economic Review

The Effects of Emergency Rental Assistance During the Pandemic: Evidence from Lotteries in Four Cities (with A. Defusco, B. Keys, J.E. Humphries, D. Phillips, V. Reina, P. Turner and W. van Dijk)
Conditionally Accepted at American Economic Journal: Economic Policy

Working Papers

"The Effects of Eviction on Children" (with D. Dutz, J.E. Humphries, N. Madar, D. Tannenbaum and W. van Dijk) *Revised & Resubmitted to Journal of Political Economy*

"In-Kind Transfers and Early Childhood Development: Evidence from Housing Assistance Lotteries" (with Chloe Gibbs) *Revise & Resubmit at Quarterly Journal of Economics*

Work in Progress

"Creating Opportunity in the Poorest Neighborhoods: Experimental Evidence from a Place-Based Employment Program" (with E. Chyn and D. Sandler)

"Public Provision v. In-Kind Vouchers: Evidence from Housing Assistance Lotteries" (with W. van Dijk and D. Waldinger)

"The Effects of Unemployment Insurance on Low-Income Families" (with E. Jenkins)

"In-Kind Transfers and Fertility: Evidence from Housing Assistance Lotteries" (with E. Davis)

"Targeting Homeless Services: Evidence from a Large-Scale RCT" (with D. Phillips and M. Cassidy)

Chapters in Edited Volumes and Other Publications

Reforming Housing Assistance (with Ingrid Gould Ellen and Jens Ludwig), 2019, *The ANNALS of the American Academy of Political and Social Science* vol. 686, 1: pp. 250-285

"Expanding Neighborhood Choices for Voucher Tenants Using Small Area Fair Market Rents" in Ingrid G. Ellen and Justin Steil, Ed. *A Dream Revisited: Contemporary Debate about Housing Segregation and Opportunity*. Columbia University Press. 2019 pp 314-316

Allocation Problems in Low-Income Housing, *More Equal by Design: Economic design responses to inequality* eds. Scott Duke Kominers and Alexander Teytelboym, Oxford University Press.

Low-Income Housing Policy (with Ingrid Gould Ellen and Jens Ludwig), 2016, , *Economics of Means-Tested Transfer Programs in the United States, Volume II*, ed. Robert Moffitt, University of Chicago Press.

Policy Briefs

"Bolstering the Housing Safety Net: The Promise of Automatic Stabilizers." (with Ben Keys and Ingrid Gould Ellen) Hamilton Project Policy Proposal 2021-02, The Brookings Institution, April 2021.

Education

Ph.D. Public Policy, New York University, 2019

M.P.P Public Policy, University of Chicago, 2009

B.A. Urban Studies, College of Wooster, 2007

Honors and Awards

New York University, University-Wide Outstanding Dissertation Award

Grants

National Science Foundation (NSF) Research Grant: SES-2018266, \$394,366 (with Eric Chyn)
 Arnold Ventures, \$100,000 (with Eric Chyn)
 Arnold Ventures, \$100,000 (with John Eric Humphries, Daniel Tannenbaum, and Winnie van Dijk)
 J-PAL North America, \$100,000 (with Mary Kate Batistich)
 J-PAL North America, \$50,000 (with David Phillips)
 J-PAL North America, \$50,000 (with David Phillips and Vincent Reina)

Seminars and Conference Presentations

2026 Institute for Research on Poverty (IRP) Summer Research Workshop (University-Wisconsin)

2025 NBER Children and Families, Cornell University, New York University, University of Wisconsin-Madison, Institute for Research on Poverty (IRP) Summer Workshop (University-Wisconsin)*, University of Notre Dame Law school

2024 NBER Economic Mobility*, Institute for Research on Poverty (IRP) Summer Research Workshop (University-Wisconsin), University of Wisconsin-Madison, School of Business, University of Illinois - Chicago, Columbia-Yale-NYU-Housing Day, DePaul University, Notre Dame Conference on Housing Markets and Housing Affordability

2023 NBER Public Economics/ NBER Labor Studies (Summer Institute), NBER Urban Economics (Summer Institute)*, NBER Public Economics (Fall Meeting)*, NBER Innovative Data in Household Finance*, Mid-Midwest Applied Micro Workshop, Urban Economics Association: Online Spatial and Urban Seminar

2022 NBER Economic Mobility, Harvard University - Opportunity Insights, AREUEA National Conference, APPAM Fall Research Conference

2021 University of Utah, Eccles School of Business, Johns Hopkins University (Virtual)*, UPenn Convening on Emergency Rental Assistance, Urban Spatial Mini-Conference, University of Notre Dame Law & Economics Workshop

2020 AEA Annual Meetings, Kansas City Federal Reserve (Cancelled), Washington University, Olin Business School (Virtual)*

2019 NBER Children (Summer Institute), Urban Economics Association Annual Meetings, AREUEA National Conference, APPAM Fall Research Conference, University of Kentucky
 *attended, co-author presented joint work

Courses Taught

University of Notre Dame
 Economics of Housing (Undergraduate)
 Public Economics (Undergraduate)
 Public Economics (PhD)

New York University
 Urban Economics (Masters)

Prior Employment

U.S. Department of Housing & Urban Development (HUD), 2009-2013

Analyst, Office of the Deputy Assistant Secretary for Policy Development, PD&R

Professional Service

Refereeing

Quarterly Journal of Economics, American Economic Review; Journal of Political Economy, Review of Economic Studies, American Economic Review: Insights; American Economic Journal: Economic Policy; American Economic Journal: Applied Economics; International Economic Review; Journal of Public Economics, Journal of Urban Economics, Journal of Health Economics, Journal of Housing Economics, Journal of Policy Analysis and Management, Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, Regional Science and Urban Economics, Quantitative Economics

Grant Reviews

National Science Foundation

Selected Media Coverage

The New York Times, The Washington Post, The Economist

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